

Child grief: remembrance, routines and traumatic reminders

Original support worksheet | School-age children and caregivers | Reviewed 2026-10-10

Use fictional or appropriately de-identified notes. Write, draw, dictate or point. Not a validated measure, diagnostic test or crisis service.

Loss understanding: What the child knows and asks

Reminder: Comforting, painful or frightening

Choice: Talk, play, object, pause

Connection + routine: Trusted people and ordinary days

Review: School, sleep, safety, questions

What I know and what I want to ask

A memory or reminder: comforting, hard, or both

A way to remember or take a break that I choose

Who helps with my day and what needs changing

Next step: who will do what, by when, and how will we review helpfulness or harm?

Assess self-harm statements, abuse, unsafe caregiving or severe functional deterioration using age-appropriate clinical procedures. Do not infer safety from playfulness or require the child to manage an adult's distress.